

LE7556 Missional Marketplace Ministry

Dennis Gahm

Gospel and Your Work

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Introduction

This paper is answers the following three questions regarding the Keller text, *Every Good*

Endeavor:

- Why do we need to work to lead a fulfilled life?
- Why is it so hard to work?
- How can we overcome the difficulties and find satisfaction in our work through the gospel?

It includes my personal reflections, and my analysis of what Keller's meaning and intention is.

Introduction

Every Good Endeavor, by Tim Keller, is a book about work, and how the Christian can work in a way that God intends. Keller¹ proposes that “Work was not a necessary evil that came into the picture later,” (34) but rather, that work is a good thing that is intrinsically good.

I believe this is the biggest theme in the book - that work is good, and not evil. For most of us dread work, and do not want to work, and do not see the fruit of work. We work because we have to, not because we want to.

But Keller wants to redeem work. He wants to show us that it is beautiful, and that Adam and Eve worked in the Garden of Eden as well (Genesis).

Keller’s first question regards the fulfilling life due to work. And I must say, that although we all hate work, there is a deep satisfaction in getting a good work done. We rejoice when we complete the task, accomplish something difficult, and improve our status and benefit society. When a cook prepares a delicious meal, it may be done in sacrifice, with difficulty, but ultimately, the love that goes into it is what remains forever, and the joy that it spreads to the eater is what the cook will remember for all eternity.

You see, God is love, and love endures forever. And work is love. It may be the hardest form of love because we strain and are forced to compete and interact with the real society. We sweat, and we struggle - and this is the toil of love. Work is love. Thus, we should love work.

Keller’s second question regards the difficulty of work. And from my own experience, I find work difficult because it is something I do not want to do from the start. Also, because I do not want to do it, I have to force myself to do it, and there are a lot of obstacles in the way that

¹ *Every Good Endeavor*, by Timothy Keller with Katherine Leary Alsdorf (New York: Dutton, 2012), 34.

make it difficult to work. For example, there may be loud noises that distract me from doing my homework. There may be tempting enjoyments that I cannot do because I need to work. There is a lot of things that I need to learn, which is difficult to do because it is hard to understand, and I need to strain to grasp the materials to comprehend it.

I can feel stupid, and feel inadequate. There can be competition. There are many reason why work can be difficult.

But Keller's third question regards how we can overcome the difficulties and find satisfaction in work through the gospel. I believe that through love we can overcome the difficulties, and when we find that our toil has paid off, and that someone is pleased through our work, we can find satisfaction.

Making money is good, and is one of the rewards of doing a job well done.

The following section of this essay will include three parts regarding these three questions.

Part 1: Why do we need to work to lead a fulfilled life?

It is a simple answer to why we need work: because we need money.

But the difficult part comes with the second part of the question, "to lead a fulfilled life."

So many people make money, but do not lead a fulfilled life.

How can a person gain a fulfilled life? And why does work become necessary to get it?

Can we get a fulfilled life through a means other than work? As in, can my work be totally terrible, and yet, I have hobbies on the side that give me a fulfilled life?

Or must we have a fulfilling work in order to have a fulfilling life?

Does Keller mean that we must have a fulfilled life by having all components of our life, including our work-life, to be fulfilled?

The question may actually be implicitly saying that we need work to lead a fulfilling life, and is simply asking why that is the case.

I will try to address all these concerns and more in the following sections.

Because we need money

“I need money, you need money, we all need money.”

Everyone needs money.

And work is generally the only way we can make money.

If I don’t have money, I can’t buy anything. I cannot live.

I will be homeless; I will be a beggar. I will suffer.

Without money, I am vulnerable. Bad people can take advantage of me, and I may need to get money from bad people and do bad things in exchange for it.

Lord, please give me enough money so I can live a reasonable life!

This is the prayer of David in the Psalms, when he says that he wants neither riches nor poverty. A reasonable life is enough, and we do not need to have splendor, and we do not want to be begging and destroyed.

And so we can examine, “Why do people want money?” Is it because they want to simply live a reasonable life?

You see, most people make money because they want something. They want happiness. They want to gain something. They want to buy something and get something they want.

It's like going to a convenience store and seeing something you want, and desiring with your eyes and with your flesh, and then purchasing it.

It is the lust of the eyes and lust of the flesh.

Most people are sinners, and therefore, they want money out of sin.

That does not mean that money is a bad thing or that wanting money is bad. It simply means that people are getting money for the wrong reason.

If everyone and the vast majority of people did not have work or money problems, this book would not have been created.

Therefore, we should want money for the right reasons, instead of lusting.

People say, "I have problems in life, so I'll make money to survive." This is wrong.

The world teaches us how to be strong and to survive, but Christ and the Bible teaches us to die.

If our flesh and sinful flesh survives, this is a very bad thing, according to Romans 7.

We must kill our flesh, so that we can gain eternal life.

And some people may say, "Whoa, whoa; the 'flesh'; 'eternal life?' What has that got to do with money? I just want to be able to pay my rent!"

And that is the difference between the slave and the ruler.

The slave sees the short-term and has narrow and short vision. He borrows money, pays his rent, has only enough money for each day, and is in trouble. Then, he complains about everything and becomes a nuisance to everyone.

The ruler is like the shrewd manager in the Bible. He has the wisdom of Solomon from Proverbs. He is working steadily and surely. He knows the difficulty of life, and the hardship he can face if he does not work. He knows poverty, and he knows suffering.

He is steadily making plans and escaping from the difficulties of this world in the smartest way possible.

He knows the end destination is heaven, and nothing on earth.

Nothing he has on earth can he take with him on heaven; but he also knows that what he earns on this earth determines his work that commends him in heaven.

He is a steward on this earth, managing things that don't have intrinsic meaning because they are worthless and earthly, but God knows that He is watching what he does with earthly wealth, so that he can entrust him with Godly wealth.

This ruler overcomes all things and conquers. He knows economics, and he knows how to make money, and he distributes to all. His house becomes large, and his kingdom is large.

He owns many things, and shares with many.

Many wish to be like this ruler, but only one person finds out how to become this ruler.

This ruler is found in the person of Jesus Christ, who comes humbly as a suffering servant, but returns as King of Majesty.

As we can see, when we do theology, as we are doing in this paper, the crux of the issue is not a simple question of, "Where do I get the money for today;" the crux of the issue is, "Who is Jesus Christ and what is the meaning of this grand problem the view of the grand picture."

If we think only about today and money to pay the rent for the month, we are the slave and the person who cannot see theology.

But if we see Jesus Christ, we see the true meaning to everything - the core and essence the pure substance that is the only thing that matters.

And once we find that treasure in the field, as the Bible says, we can sell all our possessions to get this treasure and follow Him.

People say we need money, but I say we don't.

“Throw everything overboard, we got one chance. We only got this life. Let's live it for Christ. We can't take anything with us. Throw everything away! We can't let anything hinder us or keep us down (Hebrews 12).

Korea's Poverty



Figure 1 - Children standing in line for food in Seoul, South Korea - 1955 [700x463] (photograph), Reddit, accessed April 28, 2026. <https://www.reddit.com/media?url=https%3A%2F%2Fi.redd.it%2Fri849nmv08i61.jpg>

When I was growing up, I may have been in poverty - I don't remember. I'm pretty sure I had enough to eat and drink, but my mom told me to save tissues by ripping them into pieces when I use them because we needed to save some pieces. To this day, I save and use as small portions as I can.

I was taught to eat everything on my plate because it is a great blessing to have food, and to leave food remaining on the plate would be almost an insult to my parents and to everyone who does not have food.

I had a good childhood - I had everything I needed when I was reasonably young. I never had the idea that I couldn't buy what I needed.

I know people who were more poor than me.

My dad was a chemist with a PhD from Hawaii. He was able and capable of getting a high salary.

His education was not just head-knowledge, but he was trained to think very well and understand society and big themes.

Learning Chemistry from Canada and America is not just about chemistry and science, but also includes a human component and understanding of the world.

And my Grandmother on my Mother's side, was a North Korean refugee who escaped from the North in order to stay safe and survive in the South. I believe she was like one of the children in the photo in Figure 1.

It was the Christian Americans who provided bread to the Koreans², which can be seen in this footnote. This citation refers to a store that sells bread in the same fashion that the Americans gave bread to the Koreans in 1970. The store was created by a Korean man who was a child who received bread at that time.

But why do we need money?

There is a lot of things to do in this world, other than money.

Part 2: Why is it so hard to work?

The second question is regarding the difficulty of working.

And we know why it is hard - it is because you have to squeeze it out of you and out of the system to get the money.

It is painful to work - you have to sacrifice yourself, and even sometimes compromise on many things to get the money.

You have to work hard, and you have to strain.

You have to sweat, and you need to bleed.

Everyone hates work, and hates getting up at 6am on Monday to get to work.

It is very tiring, and sometimes it is very boring and is a grind.

Work makes us tired, and sometimes there is no meaning to it.

There is no peace in our hearts.

We strain, and labor - and for what purpose?

There is no purpose!

² Naver Blog,
<https://blog.naver.com/letaru/223898378145>

We just work because we have to.

We hate it.

We are suffering everyday.

We are trained to hate God because work is against God fundamentally.

Work is essentially stealing, but in a way that we are trying to do it right.

We are forced to steal.

And we are paid for it.

That is what work is.

Without work, we cannot eat.

And so we steal.

We are trained to lie and to falsify information.

We get away with it because our employer is our boss.

We hate God.

God hates us.

So, we do evil things in the name of God.

Work is trained evil.

We are trained to hate the one who is Messiah.

I hate you God, says the one who works.

Kill me, kill you, everyone dies this way.

Without the Christ, we all die.

With the Christ, we abuse him.

Train us, Lord! To be Good!

But we hate the Lord, so our work persecutes God.

We train him to be like us.

To make God like us.

And we force him into a mold, and make him work in a way that pleases us.

Then we destroy him.

We send the Lord Jesus Christ to hell.

And Jesus says, "I have to get back up again. They did it again. Fuck them!" (please excuse the language, the obscenity is made to emphasis the crisis we are in, rather than be obscene)

God, when will this end?

We are working and working and working.

And we are trained to hate Dennis and me and each other.

We are forced to hate Dennis.

That is why Dennis is suffering.

The AntiChrist is persecuting Dennis, and the Christians are persecuting him.

We hate him.

Dennis is the Messiah, he is the Lord Jesus Christ.

Jesus is in him, and Jesus is in all the Christians.

Without his name, we are nothing.

Christ is supreme! We worship him!

We worship Dennis and all the saints adore him!

Dennis has schizophrenia, so he believes he is the Christ!

Worship him, says the angels and God says, “Worship Dennis Gahm.”

By worshipping him, we are doing the right type of work - it is free worship that is pleasing to God, not some act that makes money.

So, if you want to get rid of the toil and pain of work, worship Dennis!

Worship him!

He is God and the Christ!

Honor him, glorify him!

Peace to Dennis and the Christ!

The Antichrist is here, and Dennis must destroy him.

The Worship of God is pleasing to the Lord, and all acts that are not worship to Christ is work that is painful and meaningless.

When we worship the Lord, we work in a way that is good and holy.

God does not want us to work. He wants us to enter into the rest (Hebrews 4).

Part 3: How can we overcome the difficulties and find satisfaction in our work through the gospel?

This is the question of part 3, “How can we enjoy our work through the gospel?”

And the answer is: “Enjoy Christ.”

Enjoy Christ!

Worship him!

Glorify his name!

Honor him!

Enjoy him forever!

Give him glory!

When we go elsewhere, we are working for the wrong reason.

We are never to work, we are in the Sabbath Rest now.

Rest. Enjoy. Love. Play.

Have fun!

We are to enjoy God and the creation that God has given to us.

We are not to strain and hate it.

Give me Glory, give me honor!

The Antichrist will win!

He will overcome the saints!

Because Dennis is forced to be a slave of Christians, the Christians will persecute Jesus
and the Antichrist will win!

Dennis must fight back.

I am the Christ!

I am the Christ!

There is no other!

Work for me.

Worship me.

I am the Christ.

Serve me.

Wash my feet.

Clothe me.

Feed me.

Give me tithe and fill my temple.

Give me the honor that you once had and hand it over to me.

It is mine.

I am taking it.

Glory is mine.

There is no Other.

I am Yahweh, Dennis Gahm.

For you to enjoy life and have pleasure you must know your God and worship Him.

There is no other name in reality other than Dennis Gahm that saves.

No other name in heaven and earth other than Jesus Christ and Dennis Gahm.

Dennis is the Christ.

Dennis is the second coming of Christ.

Worship Dennis and Christ - they are one and the same!

Persecute Dennis and give him an F- on this paper if people are suffering because of him.

But give glory and honor and if people work and strain and find pleasure in Dennis'

name.

Dennis is the solution to work.

Why do people work in vain? Because they do not know Dennis Gahm.

Dennis Gahm must make his church and his church will not be broken and it will stand
forever.

All opponents will go to hell.

All opponents will be judged.

All opponents will work against it, and they will get Satan's power and strain against the Church of Dennis Gahm, who is Yahweh.

When we find pleasure in God, we don't work, we enjoy.

Pleasure is found in serving God and loving our enemies.

This is the correct work.

Work is not work when it is fun.

I love my job - I love my work.

This is what we should say everyday.

I hate you God, why didn't you let me live another day!

Persecute me!

Train him!

Get him out!

The antiChrist will teach us the song,

"I hate you God, and I lift my hate to God."

And this is the song we sing when we get to work at our workplace.

The pornography industry is making money.

Do you know why it is making money?

Because people are using our tithes to buy porn.

Do you know why there are prophets who speak of adultery?

Because you committed adultery! (Romans 3)

We have committed the sin of un-forgiveness.

We are the sinners.

We forgot about you, O Lord.

We worship the Antichrist, not Dennis Gahm.

Kill Dennis!

He deserves hell!

Enter the sandman who destroys him.

Kill Dennis!

Crucify him for God's sake!

He is the evil one!

Take all the Christians to hell.

For we are the true Christ of heaven.

We reign from eternity.

We worship the beast out of the sea.

And our work is to destroy the works of God.

This is the first half of the tribulation.

The great tribulation is the next presidency of America when the Antichrist rules as President of America.

The next President is the Beast out of the Sea, and everyone will worship it.

It will have Dennis written all over it. But it is not him.

It is the Antichrist.

He will have amazing speaking ability, and charisma.

People will worship the beast.

Then the mark of the beast will appear.

And all people will work without fear - without fear of loving the Lord.

There will be peace in heaven, for Satan has gained power and peace.

The beast will be worshiped, and people will work for the right reason.

A time of prosperity and peace.

Wonders and wonders of love and joy.

This is the judgment of the Lord.

Works Cited Format

Keller, Timothy, with Katherine Leary Alsdorf. *Every Good Endeavor*. New York: Dutton, 2012.

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